Partnership and Networking

Working Together for Greater Impact

What is Partnership and Networking?

Partnership and networking means **working with other groups** to make your work stronger, share what you have, and help more people.

When organizations join hands, they can do more together than they could alone.

Two main parts of partnership work

1

Finding Partners

(Mapping)

2

Building Partnerships

(Long-Term)

1. Finding partners (mapping potential partners)

What is Partner Mapping?

Looking around to find groups that can help your work and that you can help in return.

Why Map Partners?

- Know who is working in your area
- Find groups with similar goals
- Avoid doing the same work twice
- Share resources and knowledge
- Make your impact bigger by working together

Types of partners you can find

Local Government

City offices, health centers, schools

What they can offer:

- Permission to work in the area
- Access to public spaces
- Information about community needs
- Official support for your programs

Private Companies

Businesses, shops, factories

What they can offer:

- Money or donations
- Materials and supplies
- Skills training for your team
- Jobs for community members

More types of partners

Other NGOs

Community groups, charities

What they can offer:

- Experience and lessons learned
- Share costs of events
- Refer people who need help
- Work together on big projects

Youth Networks

Student groups, young leaders

What they can offer:

- Energy and new ideas
- Volunteers for programs
- Connection to young people
- Social media and tech skills

How to map your partners

1

List your goals

Write down what you want to achieve

Example: We want to teach 100 girls computer skills

2

Think who can help

What kind of partners would be useful?

Example: Schools with computers, tech companies, women's groups

3

Research in your area

Find actual groups and their contact information

Example: Local tech shop, Community college, Girl Scouts chapter

4

Make a partner map

Write them down with what each can offer

Example: Tech shop = computers, College = teachers, Scouts = students

2. Building strong partnerships

What makes a good partnership?

Good partnerships are:

- ✓ Fair to everyone
- ✓ Based on trust
- ✓ Working toward the same goals
- ✓ Lasting for a long time
- ✓ Helping all partners

Not good partnerships

Bad partnerships happen when:

- ✗ One partner controls everything
- ✗ Only one side benefits
- ✗ Partners don't communicate
- ✗ Goals are different
- ✗ Partnership ends quickly

Three keys to strong partnerships

Fairness (Equity)

What it means: Everyone has a voice. Everyone gives and receives. Power is shared equally.

Example: Youth group and school both decide together what programs to run. Both share costs.

Trust

What it means: Partners keep their promises. They are honest about problems. They respect each other.

Example: If a partner cannot deliver, they tell you early and work together to find a solution.

Shared goals

What it means: All partners want the same thing. They agree on what success looks like.

Example: Health center and women's group both want to reduce child sickness in the village.

How to build partnerships that last

Start small

Begin with a small project together

Why: Build trust before big commitments

One shared event before a year-long program

Celebrate together

Recognize successes and thank each other

Why: Build positive relationships

Joint celebration when goals are reached

Talk clearly

Discuss goals, expectations, and responsibilities

Why: Avoid misunderstandings later

Write down who does what and when

Be flexible

Adjust plans when things change

Why: Life is unpredictable

Change meeting times if needed

Meet regularly

Check in often to share updates and solve problems

Why: Keep partnership strong over time

Monthly meetings or phone calls

Share credit

Tell people about your partner's good work

Why: Everyone deserves recognition

Mention partners in reports and events

Real partnership success story

Youth Employment Program in Tanzania

- Local NGO (training organization)
- City government (youth department)
- Three private companies (hotels and restaurants)
- Youth network (100 young people)

What each partner gave:

- NGO: Training program and teachers
- Government: Meeting space and official support
- Companies: Job placements and mentors
- Youth: Energy, ideas, and recruited friends

Results after 2 years:

✓ 150 youth trained in hospitality skills
✓ 85 got jobs at partner companies
✓ Program continues with new youth every 6 months
✓ Partnership now in year 3 and growing

Common problems and solutions

Problem: Partners stop communicating
Solution: Set regular meeting schedule and stick to it

Problem: One partner does all the work
Solution: Write clear roles at the start. Check monthly if fair.

Problem: Goals change or conflict
Solution: Review goals together every 6 months. Adjust if needed.

Problem: Partner cannot deliver what they promised
Solution: Talk openly about problems early. Find solutions together.

Problem: Credit goes to only one partner
Solution: Always mention all partners in reports and public events.

Activities

Steps to take this month

1. Make a list of 5 possible partners
2. Contact 2 partners to discuss working together
3. Plan one small joint activity to test partnership
4. Set up regular communication (monthly meetings)
5. Write down shared goals and who does what

Key Takeaways

- ✓ **Map your partners** - find groups that share your goals
- ✓ **Build fair partnerships** - everyone gives and receives
- ✓ **Trust and communicate** - talk regularly and honestly
- ✓ **Think long-term** - good partnerships take time to grow

Together we are stronger than alone